



07-15-2025 MCS Board Meeting

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=bhk85Rj9J3s
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Community Meeting Report: Muncie Community Schools Board of Education

1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

(No statutory public hearing or committee work session was held immediately prior to calling the regular meeting to order.)

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding officer Mr. Williams called the regular meeting of the Muncie Community Schools Board of Education to order at [00:04:24](#).
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** Dr. O'Neal, Mr. Heater, Mrs. Barnes Griffin, Dr. Washburn, Mr. Low, Mr. Urban, and Presiding Officer Mr. Williams.
 - **Absent:** None.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with a moment of silence followed by the Pledge of Allegiance.
- **Approval of Minutes:** *(Not explicitly detailed in the transcript text).*

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

00:11:22 Presentation: Forest Academy at Camp Adventure

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Grim, alongside Mallerie and Heidi.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Staff presented an overview of the new Forest Academy program opening at Camp Adventure (purchased from the Optimus Club in June). The program utilizes a Montessori-inspired, nature-based learning model for 4-to-6-year-olds, blending child-led learning, outdoor exploration, and strong foundational literacy (CKLA). The class size is capped at 20 students (11 pre-K, 9 kindergarten for the initial cohort). Transportation options include parent drop-off or an MCS activity bus from Gryom Elementary. Pre-K tuition operates on a sliding scale for the first year without state voucher licensing, while kindergarten is free.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational presentation only; no formal vote taken.

00:35:31 Personnel / Consent Agenda

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Administration / Board.
- **Deliberation Summary:** The board welcomed new special education teacher Elena Wines (joining Southview Elementary) and recognized retiring special education aide Shenisha Venable after 15 years of service at Central High School.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.

00:46:27 Curriculum Item: Quaver Student Success and Resiliency Resources

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Grim.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Staff proposed adopting the Quaver Student Success and Resiliency resource package for elementary counselors, behavior interventionists, and family navigators. The music-based social-emotional learning curriculum was successfully piloted in the spring and focuses on self-awareness, self-management, and decision-making for K-3 students. The cost is \$37,800 for a three-year pre-paid license, funded out of the textbook rental (TBR) fund.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.

00:50:46 Policy Update: Student Attendance Policy

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Administration (Chuck / Legal counsel).
- **Deliberation Summary:** The board reviewed updates to the student attendance policy to align with new Indiana code extending habitual truancy tracking from grades K-6 to grades 7-12 (defining an absent student as having five unexcused absences in a 10-week period).

The policy includes newly designated excused absences for FFA, 4-H, and specific civic activities.

- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.

00:55:50 2025 Bond Project: Resolution A <U+2013> Determining the Need for the Project

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Derome.
- **Deliberation Summary:** The board considered the first of five resolutions for the 2025 bond project (totaling approximately \$19.8 million), which covers district-wide roofing, fieldhouse HVAC/boiler replacements, North Side Middle School chiller, high school exterior doors, track/tennis court resurfacing, and arena bleachers.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.

00:58:47 2025 Bond Project: Resolution B <U+2013> Approving the Form of the Lease

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Derome.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Reviewed the lease rental agreement form tied to the building corporation financing structure for the 2025 bond project.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.

00:59:47 2025 Bond Project: Building Corporation Re-approval

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Derome.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Re-approved the members of the Building Corporation (Mr. Maul, Mrs. Johnson, and Mr. Dallas) to serve for the upcoming bond project phases.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.

01:00:46 2025 Bond Project: Construction Manager as Constructor (CMC) RFP

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Derome.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Requested approval to advertise a Request for Proposals (RFP) for a Construction Manager as Constructor (CMC) for the 2025 bond project, following the successful delivery model used in previous district projects.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.

01:07:22 2025 Bond Project: Architect Services Approval

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Derome.

- **Deliberation Summary:** Recommended retaining Schmidt Associates as the architectural firm for the 2025 bond project, noting their long-standing relationship with the district.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- *No open public comment period or citizen speaker turns occurred during this meeting.*

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Dr. Reynolds reported that the first student day for the 25-26 school year is August 6, with teacher returns on August 4. Online registration support days are scheduled for July 23 and July 24.
 - A Central High School band contest featuring 23 bands is scheduled for the upcoming weekend.
 - Financial updates noted a cash balance just over \$34 million at the end of June, and the state loan balance dropping below \$7 million.
 - The next budget presentation and permission to advertise is set for the August 12 meeting.
- **Adjournment:** The meeting officially adjourned by voice vote following a motion at **00:59:18**.

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